

RELIGION AND MORALITY

FOUR RELATION MODELS → DIVINE COMMAND THEORY → EUTHYPHRO AND MODIFIED DCT → KANT AND NATURAL LAW → INDIAN MORAL GROUNDING → MOTIVATION AND CONDUCT

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g9 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

FOUR RELATION MODELS

FOUR RELATION MODELSRELIGION AND MORALITYMORALITY REQUIRES GOD/REVELATIONMORAL TRUTH IS AUTONOMOUSMORALITY IS INDEPENDENT BUT RELIGION MOTIVATES/SUSTAINS ITRELIGIOUS COMMAND OR IDENTITY CAN CONFLICT WITH MORAL JUDGEMENT

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

RELIGION AND MORALITY

DEPENDENCE: morality requires God/revelation

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

INDEPENDENCE: moral truth is autonomous

SUPPORT: morality is independent but religion motivates/sustains it

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

TENSION: religious command or identity can conflict with moral judgement separate ontology (what makes right), epistemology (how known),

one answer need not settle all four.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

(Recommended opening definition): The dependence view holds that morality requires religion for its authority, motivation or ultimate sanction, but these three claims must be assessed separately.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (Recommended opening definition): The dependence view holds that morality requires religion for its authority, motivation or ultimate sanction, but these three claims must be assessed separately.

01

STAGE 01

DIVINE COMMAND THEORY

DIVINE COMMAND THEORYGOD COMMANDS XX IS OBLIGATORY ATTRICTIONSOBJECTIVE AUTHORITYCATEGORICAL DEMANDMOTIVATION VERSIONSRIGHTNESS CONSTITUTED BY COMMAND EPISTEMICREVELATION TELLS US INDEPENDENTLY GROUNDED MORAL TRUTH MOTIVATIONAL

GOD COMMANDS X → X IS OBLIGATORY attractions: objective authority

categorical demand

motivation versions

voluntarist: rightness constituted by command epistemic: revelation tells us independently grounded moral truth motivational: love/judgement

command identification, conflicting revelations, autonomy and arbitrariness.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

GOD COMMANDS X → X IS OBLIGATORY attractions: objective authority

categorical demand

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

motivation versions

voluntarist: rightness constituted by command epistemic: revelation tells us independently grounded moral truth motivational: love/judgement strengthens compliance pressure

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

command identification, conflicting revelations, autonomy and arbitrariness.

GOD COMMANDS X → X IS OBLIGATORY attractions: objective authority

MECHANISM / VERDICT

(Recommended opening definition): Divine command theory identifies moral obligation with God's command, thereby securing authority but facing the Euthyphro dilemma between arbitrariness and independent goodness.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: (Recommended opening definition): Divine command theory identifies moral obligation with God's command, thereby securing authority but facing the Euthyphro dilemma between arbitrariness and independent goodness.

02

STAGE 02

EUTHYPHRO AND MODIFIED DCT

EUTHYPHRO AND MODIFIED DCTIS X GOOD BECAUSE GOD COMMANDS IT?MORALITY APPEARS ARBITRARY; CRUELTY COULD BECOME RIGHTGOODNESS IS INDEPENDENT; GOD IS NOT ITS FOUNDATIONMODIFIED DIVINE COMMAND THEORY

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

IS X GOOD BECAUSE GOD COMMANDS IT?

YES: morality appears arbitrary; cruelty could become right

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

NO: goodness is independent; God is not its foundation

MODIFIED DIVINE COMMAND THEORY

REPLY / RESIDUAL

God's necessarily loving/good nature grounds value divine commands flowing from that nature ground obligation reply blocks arbitrary commands

objection asks whether "good nature" is intelligible without a standard logically prior to command.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

IS X GOOD BECAUSE GOD COMMANDS IT?

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Euthyphro dilemma defeats arbitrary command, not every religious ethic; the strongest reply grounds commands in a necessarily good divine nature.

03

STAGE 03

KANT AND NATURAL LAW

KANT AND NATURAL LAW

MORAL LAW ARISES FROM RATIONAL AUTONOMY, NOT HETERONOMOUS REWARDUNIVERSAL LAW + HUMANITY AS ENDGOD AND IMMORTALITY ARE PRACTICAL POSTULATES OF HIGHEST GOODNATURAL LAW

AQUINAS JOINS RATIONAL PARTICIPATION IN ETERNAL LAW WITH DIVINEOBEY BECAUSE RATIONALLY RIGHT, NOT MERELY BECAUSE COMMANDED

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

EVALUATION / TRAP

RELIGION AND MORALITY • TILE 1/3 • same master rows 0-3234 of 8740 • continues below

03

STAGE 03 KANT AND NATURAL LAW

KANT AND NATURAL LAW

MORAL LAW ARISES FROM RATIONAL AUTONOMY, NOT HETERONOMOUS REWARD

UNIVERSAL LAW + HUMANITY AS END

GOD AND IMMORTALITY ARE PRACTICAL POSTULATES OF HIGHEST GOOD

NATURAL LAW

PRACTICAL REASON READS GOODS AND PURPOSES IN HUMAN NATURE

AQUINAS JOINS RATIONAL PARTICIPATION IN ETERNAL LAW WITH DIVINE

OBEY BECAUSE RATIONALLY RIGHT, NOT MERELY BECAUSE COMMANDED

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
KANT: moral law arises from rational autonomy, not heteronomous reward or threat categorical imperative → universal law + humanity as end	NATURAL LAW: practical reason reads goods and purposes in human nature	religion may complete moral hope without replacing moral deliberation.
God and immortality are practical postulates of highest good, not sources of duty	Aquinas joins rational participation in eternal law with divine order contrast: obey because rationally right, not merely because commanded	KANT: moral law arises from rational autonomy, not heteronomous reward or threat categorical imperative → universal law + humanity as end

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- KANT: moral law arises from rational autonomy, not heteronomous reward or threat categorical imperative → universal law + humanity as end
- God and immortality are practical postulates of highest good, not sources of duty

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- NATURAL LAW: practical reason reads goods and purposes in human nature
- Aquinas joins rational participation in eternal law with divine order contrast: obey because rationally right, not merely because commanded

EVALUATION / TRAP

- religion may complete moral hope without replacing moral deliberation.
- KANT: moral law arises from rational autonomy, not heteronomous reward or threat categorical imperative → universal law + humanity as end

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Aquinas joins rational participation in eternal law with divine order contrast: obey because rationally right, not merely because commanded;

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: For Kant, an act has moral worth when performed from a rationally self-legislated duty, not from fear of divine punishment or hope of reward.

04

STAGE 04 INDIAN MORAL GROUNDING

INDIAN MORAL GROUNDING

DHARMA KNOWN THROUGH AUTHORLESS VEDA; APŪRVA LINKS RITUAL ACT

GOD ADMINISTERS KARMA, BUT DESERTS ARISE FROM AGENTS' ACTS

INTENTION, COMPASSION AND NON-HARM WITHIN DEPENDENT ORIGINATION; NO CREATOR

AHIMŚĀ AND VOWS PURIFY JĪVA BY BLOCKING KARMIC INFLUX

DHARMA, NIŚKĀMA KARMA, DEVOTION AND KNOWLEDGE RESHAPE AGENCY

INDIAN ETHICS SHOWS OBJECTIVE DISCIPLINE WITHOUT ONE UNIFORM DIVINE-COMMAND

MĪMĀṂSĀ: dharma known through authorless Veda; apūrva links ritual act and result

NYĀYA: God administers karma, but deserts arise from agents' acts

BUDDHISM: intention, compassion and non-harm within dependent origination; no creator

JAINISM: ahimśā and vows purify jīva by blocking karmic influx

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- MĪMĀṂSĀ: dharma known through authorless Veda; apūrva links ritual act and result
- NYĀYA: God administers karma, but deserts arise from agents' acts

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- BUDDHISM: intention, compassion and non-harm within dependent origination; no creator
- JAINISM: ahimśā and vows purify jīva by blocking karmic influx

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- GĪTĀ/VEDĀNTA: dharma, niškāma karma, devotion and knowledge reshape agency
- Indian ethics shows objective discipline without one uniform divine-command model.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — MĪMĀṂSĀ: dharma known through authorless Veda; apūrva links ritual act and result

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: dharma known through authorless Veda; apūrva links ritual act and result.

05

STAGE 05 MOTIVATION AND CONDUCT

MOTIVATION AND CONDUCT

WHY BE MORAL?

FEAR OF PUNISHMENT

HOPE OF REWARD

SOCIAL BELONGING

RESPECT FOR PERSONS

LOVE OF GOOD/GOD LOWER MOTIVES MAY SECURE COMPLIANCE BUT

IT CAN ALSO RATIONALISE BIAS WHEN IDENTITY OUTRUNS UNIVERSAL

WHY BE MORAL?

fear of punishment → hope of reward → social belonging → character/virtue

respect for persons → compassion → love of good/God lower motives may secure compliance but

religiosity can support self-control, service and forgiveness

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- WHY BE MORAL?
- fear of punishment → hope of reward → social belonging → character/virtue

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- respect for persons → compassion → love of good/God lower motives may secure compliance but not moral maturity
- religiosity can support self-control, service and forgiveness

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- it can also rationalise bias when identity outruns universal concern
- TEST: conduct and reasons, not ritual profession alone, reveal moral integration.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Religion can intensify moral motivation through identity, exemplars, community and accountability, but religiosity is neither necessary nor sufficient for moral conduct.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion can intensify moral motivation through identity, exemplars, community and accountability, but religiosity is neither necessary nor sufficient for moral conduct.

06

STAGE 06 VIOLENCE NIETZSCHE AND MORAL CRITIQUE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion can intensify moral motivation through identity, exemplars, community and accountability, but religiosity is neither necessary nor sufficient for moral conduct.

STAGE 06 VIOLENCE, NIETZSCHE AND MORAL CRITIQUE

MORAL DISENGAGEMENT SAFEGUARDS

GENEALOGY EXPOSES RESENTMENT AND LIFE-DENYING SLAVE MORALITY OBJECTION TO

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
RELIGION WITHOUT MORALITY: ritual purity or orthodoxy detached from justice/compassion	rights, plural institutions, non-violence	weak verdict: both religion and anti-religious critique need independent scrutiny of consequences.
VIOLENCE PATH: exclusive truth + sacred authorisation + dehumanised out-group political grievance → moral disengagement safeguards: interpretation, conscience,	NIETZSCHE: genealogy exposes resentment and life-denying slave morality objection to Nietzsche: power may erase equality and protection of	RELIGION WITHOUT MORALITY: ritual purity or orthodoxy detached from justice/compassion

- weak verdict: both religion and anti-religious critique need independent scrutiny of consequences.
- RELIGION WITHOUT MORALITY: ritual purity or orthodoxy detached from justice/compassion

MECHANISM / VERDICT — NIETZSCHE: genealogy exposes ressentiment and life-denying slave morality objection to Nietzsche: power may erase equality and protection of weak verdict: both religion and anti-religious critique need independent scrutiny of consequences.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: genealogy exposes resentment and life-denying slave morality objection to Nietzsche: power may erase equality and protection of weak verdict: both religion and anti-religious critique need independent scrutiny of consequences.

STAGE 07 PYQ ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

CONDUCT/VIOLENCE TEST

MORALITY NEED NOT DEPEND ON DIVINE COMMAND FOR INTELLIGIBILITY

- its legitimacy depends on whether faith remains answerable to reason, dignity and justice.
- STATE precise dependence claim → separate ground/knowledge/motive/sanction

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian non-theistic and theistic models → conduct/violence test → verdict.

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

(2) A SUPREME PERSONAL LEGISLATOR CAN ISSUE UNIVERSALLY BINDING

PRESUPPOSITION. CAUTION

COMPARATIVE NUANCE